# Ratan Tata: A Life of Vision and Integrity

**Early Life**

- Born on **December 28, 1937** in Bombay (now Mumbai), India.
- Raised by his grandmother after his parents separated.
- Studied **architecture at Cornell University** and completed the **Advanced Management Program at Harvard University**.

**Career at Tata Group**

- Joined **Tata Steel in 1962**, starting on the shop floor.
- Became **Chairman of Tata Sons in 1991**, succeeding J.R.D. Tata.
- Expanded Tata Group globally with acquisitions like **Tetley Tea (2000)**, **Corus Steel (2007)**, and **Jaguar Land Rover (2008)**.
- Introduced the **Tata Nano (2009)**, the world's most affordable car.
- Retired in 2012, briefly returned as interim chairman in 2016.

**Philanthropy**

- Directed much of his wealth through **Tata Trusts**, supporting education, healthcare, and rural development.
- Invested in over **40 start-ups**, encouraging innovation in India.
- Known for his humility, ethics, and commitment to social responsibility.

**Awards**

- **Padma Bhushan (2000)** and **Padma Vibhushan (2008)**.
- International honors include **Honorary Knight Commander of the Order of the British Empire (2009)** and **Order of Australia (2023)**.

**Legacy**

- Passed away on **October 9, 2024**, at age 86 in Mumbai.
- Remembered as a visionary leader who transformed Tata Group into a global powerhouse while remaining deeply committed to philanthropy.